

Hackers arrested

Alleged LulzSec and Anonymous hackers have been arrested in California

Google checking self

When Google's Safe Browsing checked its site it found 50 pages installing malware on systems without user consent

Threat-Talk with AVG

At the launch of AVG Internet Security 2012 in Prague, we met with Yuval Ben-Itzhak, Chief Technology Officer, AVG

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Hacking will be where the money is. Hackers are no longer kids just looking for their 15 minutes of fame – they're after just one thing... your money. CTO, AVG, Yuval Ben-Itzhak described the cleverly engineered attacks and schemes that hackers are using to dupe people of their hard-earned cash. Here are some examples.

Mac Malware

As the Mac market share approaches the 10 per cent mark, so do the threats they face. Even Firefox was considered very secure initially, but as soon as it crossed the five per cent mark, hackers started taking notice. Now Firefox has almost the same amount of vulnerabilities as IE (if not more).

Last May, AVG captured an attack on iOS that fooled users into believing they're getting a message from the nonexistent Apple Security Center. The message convinced users to buy a fix for a threat that didn't exist either – a classic socially engineered attack, or scareware, as it's popularly called.

Facebook dislike?

This malware preys on the lack of an official Facebook dislike button. A need that many social networking users have felt, thanks to the inane and mundane status messages that their friends churn out by the cartload. A seemingly innocuous app comes to the rescue and

says: "Hey install this, and you can go about disliking whatever post you want". "Wowie, that's neat", you think to yourself and click install without really paying attention to what permissions and rights you've given to said application. Big mistake...

Facebook gold account

Another similar ploy preys on your desire to be part of something exclusive. When you use Facebook for as long as you do, you start craving some recognition for the endless hours you've put in. The Facebook Gold account seems like a perfect reward, but sadly has nothing to do with Facebook. All you end up with is malware.

Click Jacking

Click Jacking starts with you receiving a simple email with a link. The email usually goes something like this: "Hey watch

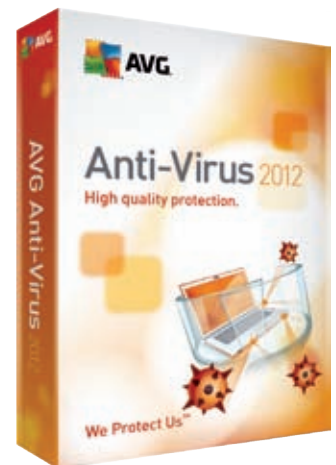
this video of a guy falling off his bike". However, when you click on the link, you're asked to fill out a small survey. Your information is gathered, and even your mobile number is collected on the pretext of ensuring you're not a bot. What you don't see is the miniature text (font size 2 or lower) that tells you your phone will be charged a certain amount every month for some service that you obviously don't want. Enough said.

Field injections

Regular online login pages of banks have been compromised recently by way of field injections. Here, there's no evidence at all of foul play because the URL is authentic right down to the https, even the SSL certificate is correct. However, there are additional fields sneakily added to the login screen, and information such as social security number, ATM PIN, your secret question, etc. are asked for. Some of these, or all of these together can compromise your bank account.

DIY hacking kits

Everyone's heard of script kiddies, and now that phrase actually rings truer than ever before. Any idiot with a PC and a desire to hack can get his hands on kits that cost about \$100, and contain all the tools and basic knowledge one would need to exploit unsuspecting victims. These kits are so sophisticated that they have their own reporting tools and even automatic updates!



AVG Anti-Virus 2012 launched for ₹799 and is available via Milestone Interactive

Android malware / Premium SMS scam

Android being an open operating system allows users to install applications from other marketplaces or app stores, other than the official one from Google. So, say you want Angry Birds, but you don't want to pay for it. You'll look for a version on other marketplaces and sure enough you find Angry Birds Rio. It's malware, and is reverse engineered with a piece of code added that will execute once you get to Stage Three of the game. A silent message is sent to a premium number, and since these numbers charge extra for their services, the malware maker gets paid by your mobile operator instead of him stealing directly from you. Malware makers are now using legitimate transaction modes to make money.

One additional threat that is starting to appear is a malware that targets Bitcoin – an electronic wallet service that people use to make micro payments online. The malware attempts to gain access to your e-wallet, much like an e-pickpocket. As Yuval puts it, "You don't even need to leave your home or use your credit card online. Hackers will always come to where the money is..." **d**



Yuval Ben-Itzhak, Chief Technology Officer, AVG Technologies